

## SCHOOL - COMMUNITY COMMUNICATIONS AND COMMUNITY INVOLVEMENT

The School Board believes that effective two-way communication between the School Board and the public is essential to the development and support of a sound public education system.

In order to operate effectively and with public trust, the School Board must maintain open lines of communication with all segments of the community, including parents, teachers, students, non-parents, senior citizens, businesses, and civic organizations. Open lines of communication can be used to disseminate information and obtain feedback toward the goal of maintaining and enhancing the educational system.

A. Participation by the Public in School Board Meetings. The Board will seek means of informing the community of educational programs, accomplishments, and needs. The Board encourages citizens to communicate their views and concerns. One method of citizen communication to the School Board is by addressing the Board at its regular meetings. Policy 2520 gives direction for public participation at School Board meetings.

B. Media. The School Board recognizes the importance of the media in the maintenance of communications with the community. The School Board as a whole and as individuals will endeavor to promote a cooperative relationship with all media representatives by providing information and encouraging coverage of School Board and Loudoun County Public Schools activities through the LCPS Public Information Office.

C. Community Involvement. The School Board encourages a high degree of community involvement through participation in parent-teacher organizations or associations, visitation of schools, acting as volunteers in the schools, serving as resource persons, serving on advisory committees of the School Board or individual schools, participating in school booster organizations, and in other ways. Persons wishing to do so should contact the principals of schools or their School Board representative.

### D. School Board Members' Electronic Newsletters

1. Purpose. The intent of School Board member e-newsletters is to provide LCPS families with information pertaining to School Board business and select LCPS "news to know". Newsletters that include an LCPS or LCSB logo, are posted on the School Board member's LCPS webpage or use division resources for dissemination shall not contain election campaign information. School Board members may have separate newsletters for campaign purposes, which will not use an LCPS or LCSB logo, be hosted on the LCPS website, linked to the LCPS site, distributed through LCPS, or prepared with LCPS resources. This policy does not impede School Board members from distributing newsletters through other mechanisms.

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2. Disclaimer. Every e-newsletter must contain the following disclaimer within the first quarter of the newsletter, in a font that is equal in size to the text: "The views contained herein reflect the views of the individual School Board member who is the publisher of this newsletter and may not reflect the views of the Loudoun County School Board and/or Loudoun County Public Schools."

3. Subscription. Every e-newsletter will contain an option to unsubscribe from further communication for the remainder of the academic year, if desired, in a font that is equal in size to the text contained therein.

4. Frequency. School Board members may produce an e-newsletter that LCPS will disseminate via email to families within their district as reflected in the student information system as of the date of the newsletter, with no more frequency than monthly. School Board e-newsletters will also be published on the respective Board members' webpage following their monthly e-newsletter schedule and may also be distributed via additional channels.

5. Logo. School Board members' e-newsletters may carry an LCPS or LCSB logo, even though they may not necessarily reflect the position of the school system or School Board as a whole.

6. Content. School Board members may use existing content generated by LCPS, including news releases, media tips, newswire, or any other LCPS published material. Newsletter content:

- a. shall address topics relating to LCPS;
- b. shall adhere to LCPS policies and regulations, specifically including but not limited to, those relating to Policy 1030, acceptable use, respect of confidential information, non-disclosure of personnel records, non-disclosure of identifiable student information (without written permission of a parent or adult student); shall not contain false information; and
- c. may not disclose other information that the Virginia Freedom of Information Act (VFOIA) allows LCPS to withhold. Examples include, but are not limited to, advice of division counsel, information shared in closed meetings, safety and security plans, medical records, investigations, etc.
- d. shall be available in both English and Spanish and, shall be translated into other languages or large text format at stakeholder request.
- e. shall comply with ADA accessibility requirements for websites and electronic media.

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7. Review, Approval, and Timing. E-newsletters shall be reviewed and approved by Division Counsel to ensure compliance with School Board policies and applicable laws, within two business days of submission.

- a. Upon final approval of Division Counsel, the e-newsletter shall be submitted by the Board member to staff in the Public Information Office (PIO), fully formatted and ready for distribution.
- b. PIO staff shall distribute the approved e-newsletter within two business days of receiving it from the School Board member.
- c. If staff or Division Counsel believe that the submitted e-newsletter may not abide by section 6 of this policy, staff will refer the e-newsletter back to the submitting School Board member for revisions at which time the approval timeline will be reset. If the Board member determines that revisions are not warranted, the e-newsletter shall be submitted to the Board Chair and Vice-Chair for review and if either individual believes that the submitted e-newsletter may not abide by section 6 of this policy, then the e-newsletter will be submitted to the full School Board, within applicable VFOIA timelines, for a determination of whether it meets section 6 requirements at the next public meeting.

E. Where communications are not directly addressed to School Board members for specific purposes (e.g., the communication pertains to an item pending before a certain School Board committee and the communication is addressed to the committee's chair), School Board members are generally expected to respond to communications received from those constituents residing within their respective voting districts. For example, this would encompass communications from those families who would customarily receive the School Board member's electronic newsletter. In an effort to streamline and clarify such communication protocol, LCPS school websites should list only the Board member who represents the families of the voters residing within the voting district that encompasses that school building. The At-Large School Board member should also be listed on all schools' websites as a secondary School Board member contact.

[Former Policy 2-28)

Adopted: 6/9/87

Revised: 6/22/93, 8/10/10, 10/25/16, 6/23/20, 9/28/21

Current Revision: 4/8/25

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Leg Ref: Va. Code § [22.1-253.13:7](#)(C)(4)

Cross Ref: [2520](#), Participation by the Public